

with Apple (who had come out with their own Graphical OS—the Macintosh OS—in 1984) if they copied any of the fea-

tures of the Mac OS. For example, Apple believed it held the rights to the concept of a “Trash Bin,” which stored files before they were permanently deleted. Further development on Windows was seriously threatened, and Microsoft averted it by signing a licensing agreement with Apple which let them use the same features that Apple offered, in all the current and future versions of Windows.

Windows 1.0 System Requirements

MS DOS 2.0
256 KB RAM
2 Floppy Disk Drives or a Hard Drive

Windows 1.0 had little luck in the market. It was slow, and plagued by hardware and software compatibility issues. Applications for Windows were little more than toys, and there was no real reason for business users to use it. Its breath of life came when *Aldus Pagemaker*, a popular page-layout software for the Macintosh, came out with a version for Windows, finally giving Windows the status of a credible OS. Now that Microsoft saw a future in Windows, it was time to spruce it up.

Cleaned up—Windows 2.0

Microsoft released Windows 2.0 in 1987 to take advantage of the awesome processing power of the Intel 286 processor. It was released with the same, if not greater fanfare as Windows 1.0, and sported a much better look. It introduced the concept of maximising and minimising windows, and now that they had signed the agreement with Apple, Microsoft even introduced overlapping windows, which they couldn’t have before. They also made the [Alt] key bring up the main menu—something still present in all Windows programs.

Windows 2.0 also saw the introduction of the first versions of Microsoft Word and Excel. Other software developers were also sitting up and taking notice of this new OS and started developing applications for it. They didn’t pack up their DOS applications just yet, for Windows was still new on the scene and was used only by a minority.